Technical and Business Writing

Mid Long Questions (4 marks each) · Simple English, matched to the slides and notes

#	Long question	Source	Priority
1	Writing Situation: Audience, Purpose, Context	Unit 1 · Lecture 1 · Lecture 2	Must do
2	7 Cs of Communication	7 Cs notes	Must do
3	Email Writing	Lecture 1 · Class work	Must do
4	General vs Technical vs Business Writing	Lecture 1 · Unit 1	Backup
5	Technical Writing Process	Lecture 2 · Unit 1	Backup
6	Brainstorming (with mind map)	Lecture 2 · Done in class	Must do

How to write a 4-mark long: Introduction (1–2 lines) → Table or points → One example → Conclusion (1 line).

LONG 1: Writing Situation (Audience, Purpose, Context)

Unit 1 (1.2) · Lecture 1 (slides 5, 20–21) · Lecture 2 (slide 7)

Q. Explain the writing situation: audience, purpose and context.

Introduction

Before writing, a writer must ask **three questions**: Who will read it? Why am I writing? Where will it be read? This is called the **writing situation**.

1. Audience: Who will read it?

Different readers know different things and need different things. There are 4 types:

Audience	What they want
Experts	Data and proof
Technicians	Clear steps
Managers	Short summary, cost and risks
Laypeople / Clients	Simple words and benefits

2. Purpose: Why am I writing?

What should the reader do after reading?

- **Inform:** tell what happened (e.g. progress report)
- **Instruct:** tell how to do something (e.g. installation guide)
- **Persuade:** make someone agree (e.g. proposal)

3. Context: Where and how will it be read?

On a phone, in a meeting or near a machine? Is it urgent? Context decides the **length, look and tone** of the document.

Example: same news, two readers

- **Developer:** "The login fails because the database table has no index."
- **Manager:** "Students cannot log in. It will take 2 days to fix and cost nothing."

Conclusion: When we know the audience, purpose and context, we can write the **right thing** in the **right way**.

Yaad karne ki trick: Kaun parhega? (Audience) · **Kyun** likh raha hoon? (Purpose) · **Kahan/kaise** parhega? (Context)

LONG 2: 7 Cs of Communication

7 Cs notes (Mind Tools)

Q. Explain the 7 Cs of communication with examples.

Introduction

The 7 Cs are a **checklist** for good communication. They make our emails, reports and meetings **clear and effective**.

C	Meaning	Example
1. Clear	Easy to understand; reader does not guess	Say which Daniel and what you want
2. Concise	Short; no extra words	Remove "kind of", "basically"
3. Concrete	Gives exact details	"Packs lunch in 1 minute"
4. Correct	No spelling or grammar mistakes	"two-**week**", not "two-**weak**"
5. Coherent	Logical; one topic in one email	Report and meeting in separate emails
6. Complete	Gives all needed information	Give the meeting **time and place**
7. Courteous	Polite and kind	"Could my team get extra time, please?"

Conclusion: If we follow the 7 Cs, people **understand** us easily and **trust** us.

Yaad karne ki trick: Saaf · Chhota · Pakka · Sahi · Jura · Poora · Tameez
(Clear · Concise · Concrete · Correct · Coherent · Complete · Courteous)

LONG 3: Email Writing

Lecture 1 (slides 13–14) · Class work · 7 Cs

Q. What is a professional email? Explain its parts and write an example.

Introduction

An email is the **most common way** to communicate at work. A good email is **short, clear and polite**.

Parts of a professional email

Part	What to write
1. Subject	What the email is about
2. Salutation	Polite greeting: "Dear Sarah,"
3. Purpose	Why you are writing
4. Details	Dates, times, names
5. Request	What you want, and **by when**
6. Closing	"Thank you," and your name

Bad email vs Good email (slide 14)

Bad email:
Subject: report
Hey, I need the project report ASAP. Send it over now.
Problems: rude, no deadline, no greeting, which report?

Good email:
Subject: Request: Updated Sprint 4 Progress Report
Dear Sarah,
Please send the updated Sprint 4 progress report by 3:00 PM today so we can review it before the client meeting.
Thank you,
Alex
Good points: clear subject, polite greeting, exact time, gives the reason.

Conclusion: A good email follows the **7 Cs**: it is clear, short, complete and polite.

Yaad karne ki trick: S-S-P-D-R-C: "**S**ubject, **S**alaam, **P**urpose, **D**etails, **R**equest, **C**losing"

If the paper says "Write an email to…": use these same 6 parts and only change the topic.

LONG 4: General vs Technical vs Business Writing

Lecture 1 (slides 6, 11, 15–16) · Unit 1 (1.1)

Q. Differentiate between general, technical and business writing.

Definitions

- **Technical writing:** explains technical information **clearly and correctly** to a **specific reader**.
- **Business writing:** writing used **at work** to share information and help **make decisions**.

General vs Technical writing

Basis	General Writing	Technical Writing
Purpose	To entertain	To inform or help do a task
Reader	Anyone	A specific reader
Tone	Emotional	Factual
Structure	Free	Headings, lists, tables
Words	Creative	Exact technical words

Technical vs Business writing

Basis	Technical Writing	Business Writing
Focus	Software and systems	Work and decisions
Documents	Manuals, API docs, SRS	Emails, memos, proposals
Reader	Developers, users	Managers, clients

Both: proposals and feasibility reports are technical **and** business documents.

Conclusion: A computer professional needs **both** technical and business writing.

Yaad karne ki trick: General = **dil** ki baat · Technical = **system** ki baat · Business = **faisle** ki baat

LONG 5: Technical Writing Process

Lecture 2 (slides 4–5) · Unit 1 (1.5)

Q. Explain the stages of the technical writing process.

Introduction

Good writing does not start by just typing. Writers follow **steps**.

Stage	What happens
1. Idea	Choose the topic or problem
2. Planning	Decide the reader, purpose and what to include
3. Gathering	Collect information
4. Reviewing	Check the information is correct and useful
5. Organizing	Put information in order (outline)
6. Drafting	Write the first version
7. Revising	Improve it and finish it

It is a cycle: the writer can **go back** to an earlier step if something is missing. It is not a straight line.

Example: while writing, the writer finds the cost data missing and goes back to collect it.

Conclusion: Following these steps gives a **clear and correct** document.

Yaad karne ki trick: "**I**dea **P**lan **G**ather **R**eview **O**rganize **D**raft **R**evise" → "**I**k **P**akistani **G**har **R**aat **O**r **D**in **R**oshan"

LONG 6: Brainstorming

Lecture 2 (slides 24–29) · Done in class

Q. What is brainstorming? Explain its techniques with an example.

Introduction

Brainstorming means **producing ideas** before deciding how they will appear in the final document. At this stage we do **not** write polished sentences.

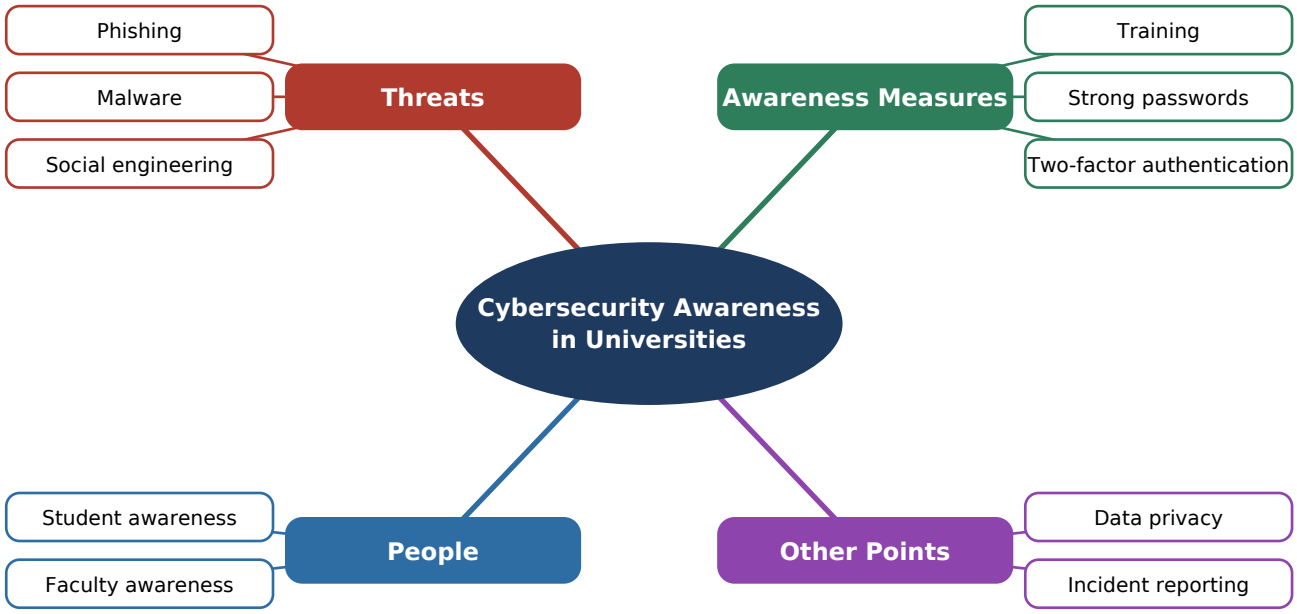
What we do in brainstorming

- **Generate ideas:** think of points and questions
- **Explore aspects:** look at the topic from different sides
- **Discover subtopics:** break a big topic into small parts
- **Delay editing:** do not reject an idea just because it is not well written

Techniques of brainstorming

Technique	Meaning	Example
1. Freewriting	Write ideas **non-stop** without editing	"Problems with our LMS…" and keep writing
2. Listing	**List everything** about the topic	security, cost, users, training
3. Questioning	Ask **Who? What? Why? When? Where? How?**	Questions show missing areas
4. Mind mapping	Put the **topic in the centre** and connect ideas around it	See the diagram below

Example: mind map (Cybersecurity Awareness in Universities)



From ideas to an outline



Formal outline (slide 29)

I. Introduction
II. Common Cybersecurity Threats
  A. Phishing B. Malware C. Social Engineering
III. Awareness Measures
  A. Training B. Strong Passwords C. Two-Factor Authentication
IV. Recommendations
V. Conclusion

Conclusion: Brainstorming helps the writer find **all the ideas first**, and then organize them into an outline.

Yaad karne ki trick: F-L-Q-M: "**F**ree **L**ist **Q**uestion **M**ap" (Freewriting, Listing, Questioning, Mind mapping)

In the paper: draw a small mind map (topic in the centre, 3–4 branches). It earns easy marks.